

F5 Daily Briefing - Monday, July 27, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

16

ANNOUNCEMENTS

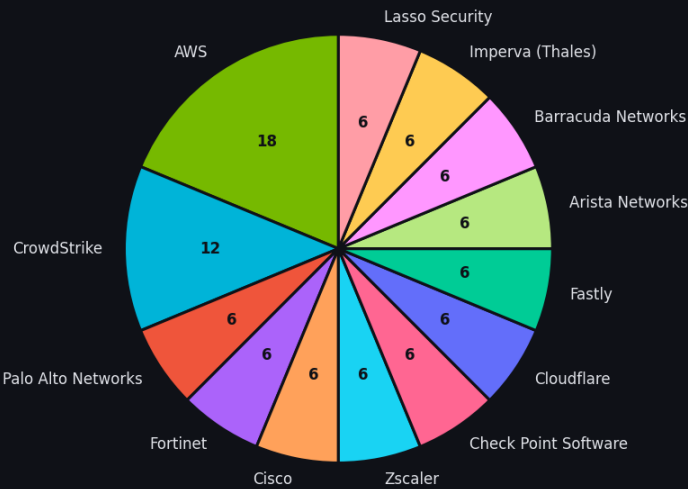
13

ACTIVE

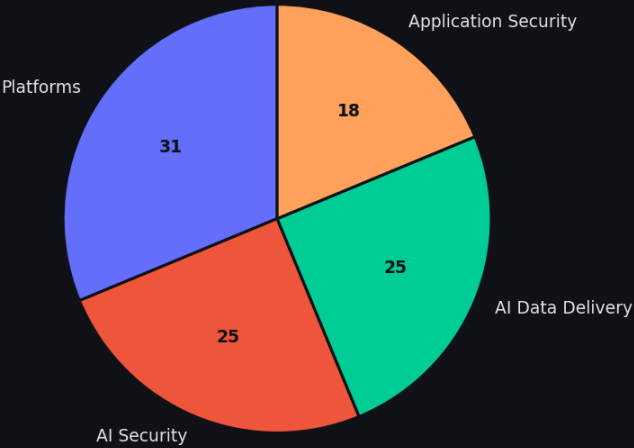
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (16)

THREAT RESEARCH

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-27

Unit 42 Warns of 'Phantom Squatting' AI-Hallucinated Domains

Palo Alto Networks' Unit 42 researchers warned about 'phantom squatting,' where LLMs and AI coding agents invent credible-sounding but non-existent domain names for sites, APIs, and services. Attackers can pre-register these hallucinated domains to redirect AI-initiated traffic for phishing, malware, or data interception. Analyzing 913 brands, Unit 42 found roughly 250,000 unregistered AI-invented domains and 13,229 malicious URLs among 2.1 million queried. The team advises against automatically trusting AI-generated URLs and recommends independent domain-ownership verification before agents access external sites.

<https://au.marketscreener.com/news/palo-alto-networks-warns-about-a-phantom-squattinga--ce7f51dcda8af523>

PARTNERSHIP**Fortinet**

2026-07-27

Fortinet and Intel Partner to Build Security Processor 6 (SP6)

Fortinet and Intel announced a strategic collaboration to co-develop the Fortinet Security Processor 6 (SP6), pairing Fortinet's purpose-built security ASIC expertise with Intel's semiconductor design, packaging, and manufacturing. The partnership aims to accelerate SP6 development, boost security performance and efficiency for enterprise and AI-enabled workloads, and strengthen the resilience and diversity of Fortinet's global supply chain. Both companies signaled potential for deeper cooperation across semiconductor technology and manufacturing to support Fortinet's long-term custom-silicon roadmap.

<https://cxotoday.com/cybersecurity/intel-and-fortinet-team-up-to-boost-cybersecurity-and-supply-chain-resilience/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-07-27

Cisco Introduces Antares Open AI Models for Vulnerability Detection

Cisco unveiled Antares, a family of compact, open-weight small language models (Antares-350M and Antares-1B) built to localize and detect software vulnerabilities directly within an organization's own codebase and infrastructure. Released openly to developers and security teams, the models run on-premises or in private clouds, avoiding cloud egress, data-privacy risks, and the high compute cost of frontier models. Cisco positions Antares as a privacy-first, cost-efficient alternative that outperforms larger models at vulnerability localization, with a roadmap toward automated patch generation and CI/CD integration.

<https://www.zawya.com/en/press-release/cisco-introduces-antares-a-family-of-super-efficient-ai-models-for-detecting-software-vulnerabilities-411627>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-27

Cato Networks and CrowdStrike Harmonize SASE with Falcon

CrowdStrike announced a new integration with Cato Networks that unifies Cato's SASE platform with CrowdStrike Falcon. The integration correlates network telemetry with endpoint detections, merging Cato XOps with Falcon Discover to enrich endpoint context and feed network signals into Falcon SIEM. The result is broader threat visibility, faster investigations, and improved device intelligence and threat hunting. The move expands CrowdStrike's SASE partner ecosystem alongside Zscaler, Netskope, and Versa, positioning combined network-and-endpoint context for faster response to modern, AI-driven threats.

<https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/cato-networks-and-crowdstrike-harmonize-sase-with-falcon/>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-27

CrowdStrike Joins NVIDIA-Led Open Secure AI Alliance

CrowdStrike joined the Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAI) as an inaugural partner alongside NVIDIA, Microsoft, and dozens of tech and cybersecurity leaders. The coalition builds on Linux Foundation efforts to advance open tools, models, agent harnesses, and defensive techniques for AI-enabled infrastructure, spanning agent identity, isolation, safe model distribution, multi-model vulnerability scanning, and red-team tooling.

CrowdStrike said it will share insights on using open models for AI defense and is developing techniques that turn open models into detectors for AI and agentic attacks, with more detail expected at Fal.Con.

<https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/crowdstrike-joins-the-open-secure-ai-alliance/>

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP**Zscaler**

2026-07-27

Zscaler Extends Zero Trust to the AI Data Plane vs. the 'Lethal Trifecta'

Zscaler argued that AI shifts the trust boundary to the data plane and framed the 'lethal trifecta' as zero trust's next frontier. Having operationalized zero trust for the network and identity, Zscaler said protecting data now requires applying zero-trust rigor to data access and exfiltration prevention. The company is folding Symmetry's AI access graph into its platform to map which identities and agents can touch sensitive data, closing data-exfiltration and prompt-injection paths and extending its zero-trust approach to autonomous AI agents.

<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/product-insights/lethal-trifecta-zero-trust>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Check Point Software**

2026-07-27

Check Point SmartConsole Auth-Bypass Flaw Added to CISA KEV

Check Point issued an update on CVE-2026-16232, an authentication-bypass flaw in its Security Management, Multi-Domain Management, and Security Gateways that is under active exploitation. Attackers could obtain an application token via SmartConsole, gain full administrative privileges, and alter security policies. CISA added the bug to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog and urged federal agencies to patch. Check Point's July 27 Threat Intelligence Report reiterated hotfix availability and urged customers to restrict internet-exposed management interfaces, enforce MFA, and apply the July jumbo hotfix.

<https://www.scworld.com/news/checkpoint-authentication-bypass-bug-exploited-added-to-cisa-list>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-07-27

Cloudflare Open-Sources pvcli Privacy-Protocol Debugger for AI Agents

Cloudflare open-sourced pvcli (privacy-client), an Apache 2.0 command-line debugger for privacy-protocol traffic (OHTTP and MASQUE) with AI agents as a primary intended user. Modeled on curl for ease of use, pvcli lets smaller teams test and debug privacy-proxied traffic without deep protocol expertise, leveraging Cloudflare's existing Privacy Proxy and Privacy Gateway infrastructure. It improves visibility and troubleshooting for privacy-preserving infrastructure used by features like Apple's privacy tools and Microsoft Edge's Secure Network VPN, with initial OHTTP support and MASQUE support planned.

<https://thenewstack.io/cloudflare-pvcli-privacy-debugger-agents/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-07-27

AWS Expands Global Footprint with Athens Local Zone and .NET Durable Execution

AWS's weekly roundup highlighted several launches, including a new AWS Local Zone in Athens, Greece adding data-residency options with support for EC2 C7i/M7i/R7i, S3 One Zone-IA, EBS, and ECS. AWS also announced general availability of a Lambda durable execution SDK for .NET, enabling long-running, resilient workflows with automatic checkpointing and pause capability up to a year without an external orchestrator. Additional updates spanned Amazon Connect voice AI, SageMaker Unified Studio OpenSearch querying, and CloudWatch coding-agent insights.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-july-27-2026/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-07-27

Anthropic Claude Opus 5 Now Available on Amazon Bedrock

AWS made Anthropic's Claude Opus 5 available through Amazon Bedrock and the Claude Platform on AWS, bringing Opus-tier model performance to enterprise inference workloads with zero data retention by default. The addition strengthens Bedrock's managed model-serving catalog, letting customers route high-capability generative AI traffic through AWS's fully managed infrastructure. It reinforces AWS's position as a delivery layer for frontier models, complementing broader launches around agentic voice experiences and AI observability announced the same week.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-july-27-2026/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-27

AWS Shield Advanced Adopts WAF Anti-DDoS Managed Rule Group

AWS began rolling out the AWS WAF Anti-DDoS managed rule group to eligible Shield Advanced web ACLs, upgrading Layer-7 DDoS protection. Starting July 27, the rule group deploys in Count mode across a phased migration running through year-end, with automatic protection remaining active and no traffic interruption. A free evaluation period lets customers run existing automatic mitigation and the new rule group in parallel, with DDoS metrics, WAF labels, and an Anti-DDoS dashboard available. Guided and automatic migration paths help customers transition on their own schedule.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/aws-shield-advanced-is-embracing-the-aws-waf-anti-ddos-managed-rule-group-what-changes-and-how-to-prepare/>

PARTNERSHIP**Fastly**

2026-07-27

Fastly Joins Experian Agent Trust to Verify AI Agents at the Edge

Fastly joined Experian's Agent Trust ecosystem to enable trusted AI commerce at the network edge, verifying AI-agent identities, evaluating trust signals, and authorizing transactions in real time before requests reach origin infrastructure. Using Experian's Human-to-Agent Binding and Agent Trust Token, Fastly can distinguish trusted autonomous agents from untrusted ones and apply identity-based access and pricing controls without backend re-architecture, integrating Know Your Agent technologies to validate credentials in milliseconds. The move positions Fastly as a potential enforcement point in agentic commerce as automated traffic surpasses half of web activity.

<https://itdigest.com/quick-byte/fastly-partners-with-experian-to-drive-ai-agent-verification-at-the-network-edge/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Arista Networks**

2026-07-27

Arista Patches Actively Exploited VeloCloud Orchestrator Zero-Day

Arista Networks disclosed and patched CVE-2026-16812, a maximum-severity (CVSS 10.0) unauthenticated OS command-injection zero-day in on-premises VeloCloud Orchestrator that is being actively exploited. The flaw lets remote attackers access privileged internal functions and potentially take full control of the orchestrator; hosted and dedicated deployments were patched earlier. CISA added the bug to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog and set a federal remediation deadline. Fixes are available in VCO 5.2.3.14, 6.1.3.4, 6.4.2.4, and 7.0.0.1; Arista urged immediate upgrades and IP-based restrictions.

<https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/arista-patches-velocloud-orchestrator-zero-day-exploited-in-attacks/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Barracuda Networks**

2026-07-27

Barracuda Managed XDR Adds Automated Threat Response for Duo

Barracuda announced that its Managed XDR now includes Automated Threat Response (ATR) for Cisco Duo, enabling hands-free containment of identity-based attacks. ATR monitors identity activity such as anomalous logins, MFA manipulation, and fraudulent push requests, correlating it with cloud and SaaS activity across Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, AWS, Azure, Entra ID, and Okta. When compromise is detected, affected accounts are disabled within seconds, sessions revoked, and malicious sign-ins blocked without manual escalation, closing the gap between detection and containment before attackers can escalate or move laterally.

<https://blog.barracuda.com/2026/07/27/when-identity-is-compromised-seconds-matter>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Imperva (Thales)**

2026-07-27

Imperva Cloud WAF Release Adds New SIEM Violation Types

Thales published Imperva's Cloud Application Security release notes for its late-July update, adding two new Cloud WAF SIEM violation types, Unrestricted File Upload and Sensitive Information Leakage, to improve threat telemetry. The release also introduced a Client-Side Protection beta that automatically authorizes trusted domains in Enforce mode to reduce manual reviews, and delayed an API Security schema-protection change for OPTIONS and HEAD requests. Several recently mitigated CVEs were noted, alongside a known issue affecting post-quantum TLS configuration updates via API.

<https://docs-cybersec-be.thalesgroup.com/bundle/cloud-application-security/page/release-notes/2026-07-26.htm>

MEDIA FEATURE**Lasso Security**

2026-07-27

The Hacker News Profiles Lasso's AI Security Platform

The Hacker News published an in-depth profile of Lasso Security's AI security platform, examining how the company safeguards organizations as LLMs and AI agents proliferate across enterprise workflows. The piece details Lasso's approach to AI-driven security threats, spanning observability, governance, and real-time defense across AI/ML pipelines, and how it fits into modern AI and cloud security strategies. Coverage reinforces Lasso's positioning around intent-based LLM protection, gateway-level guardrails, and end-to-end agent security as AI adoption accelerates.

<https://thehackernews.com/expert-insights/2026/07/a-look-inside-lassos-ai-security.html>